

liant minds of the late '70s and '80s which paved the way that eventually leads to hardware-less game distribution via the cloud. The methods of distributing games to the public has also been ever changing. And as the technology became more advanced, there were gates opened to bigger, more heavier games. We shall look in detail at the various ways in which video games have been stored and distributed throughout the years. We shall also look at the various setbacks and restraints that each of these methods have had to face.

Extra Terrestrial : The Video Game

The year was 1982 and the video game industry was booming. The game developers lived the life of rockstar geeks with their funky offices and dangerous habits. It was at this time that game developer Howard Warshaw was given the task of designing a game to match up with a release of the E.T. movie. He was given a time period of 2 months to get the job done. Warshaw was a very successful game developer and had designed titles like Yars' Revenge and Raiders of the Lost Ark for Atari. He met the deadline and as cartridges used to be the standard distribution medium, millions of copies were made and stored in warehouses, ready for customer disposal. Nothing could go wrong, except one thing; E.T. was a horrible, buggy mess

of a game. It was openly ridiculed for being silly, pointless and downright bad. The game became a joke in pop culture. So, we wonder, what then happened to all the cartridges that Atari had already produced?

Each video game distribution medium has its certain drawbacks too and has to deal with piracy. To develop such a system where the content from the developers' desk reaches the consumer in the way that the developer wants, is still as important a task in the game life-cycle as it was back in those times.

Let us have a look at the various game distribution systems from the early years of gaming.



This game became quite a cultural phenomena back in the '80s